

SCIENTIFIC FOUNDATIONS OF HEALTH

21SFH19- MODULE-4

Avoiding risks and harmful habits:

- Characteristics of health compromising behaviors
- Recognizing and avoiding of addictions
- how addiction develops and addictive behaviors
- Types of addictions
- Differences between addictive people and non addictive people
- Effects and health hazards from addictions

Characteristics of health compromising behaviors

- ❖ The six health-compromising behaviors (low fruit consumption, high sweet consumption, less frequent tooth brushing, low physical activity, physical fighting and smoking) clustered into two clusters.
- ❖ The first cluster included low fruit consumption, less frequent tooth brushing and low physical activity.
- ❖ The second cluster included high sweets consumption, smoking and physical fighting.

Recognizing and avoiding of addictions

- Recognizing an addiction problem in someone you know can be harder than it seems.

The [American Society of Addiction Medicine \(ASAM\)](#) defines addiction as a chronic disease that affects the brain's reward, motivation, and memory functions. Someone with an addiction will crave a substance or other behavioral habits. They'll often ignore other areas of life to fulfill or support their desires.

General signs of addiction are

- Lack of control, or inability to stay away from a substance or behavior
- Decreased socialization, like abandoning commitments or ignoring relationships
- Ignoring risk factors, like sharing needles despite potential consequences
- Physical effects, like withdrawal symptoms or needing higher dosage for effect

Substance addiction is dependence on any one or more
of the following:

- nicotine, or tobacco
- alcohol
- inhalants, often household items like oven cleaners, spray paints, or other aerosol products
- drugs, illicit or non-illicit
- medication

Behavioral addiction can include:

- gambling
- working
- shopping
- video games
- using the Internet or media

Signs that point towards changes in their health can include:

- bloodshot or glazed eyes
- constant illness
- unexplained injuries
- abrupt change in weight
- bad skin, hair, teeth, and nails (especially when substance abuse involves illicit drugs like methamphetamines or cocaine)
- increased tolerance to drugs
- physical withdrawal symptoms like sweating, trembling, or vomiting
- memory loss or problems with recall
- change in speech like slurred words or rapid rambling

The following mental and emotional changes could also be signs of an addiction problem:

- sudden changes in mood
- aggressive behavior
- irritability
- depression
- apathy
- suicidal thoughts



Types of addictions

Today, most experts recognize two types of addiction:

- **Chemical addiction.** This refers to addiction that involves the use of substances.
- **Behavioral addiction.** This refers to addiction that involves compulsive behaviors. These are persistent, repeated behaviors that you carry out even if they don't offer any real benefit.



we'll explore some of the serious health conditions that may be caused or worsened by substance abuse, including:

- Diminished immune system function and infection.
- Cardiovascular problems.
- Gastrointestinal issues.
- Respiratory problems.
- Liver damage.
- Kidney damage.
- Neurological issues.